

Guidelines on the Responsible Use of Artificial Intelligence

1. Foreword

The adoption of artificial intelligence (AI), especially generative models, is deeply transforming the world of research, including policy and think tank research, and more generally the work in organisations.

AI technologies offer significant opportunities to accelerate data collection, analysis and content production processes, but they also raise ethical, legal and deontological issues that require careful consideration and of which researchers and staff need to become aware.

In this context, the Istituto Affari Internazionali adopts a set of guidelines to ensure a responsible use of AI, in accordance with principles outlined at the national and international levels, such as the European [AI ACT](#) and the European Commission's [Living Guidelines on the Responsible Use of Generative AI in Research](#).

2. Basic principles for the use of AI

The use of generative AI technologies by researchers and staff must be guided by a set of fundamental principles. These principles establish whether and under what conditions the use of AI technologies is permitted for specific processes or activities that fall within the scope of IAI.

2.1 Human agency and supervision

The principle of human agency and supervision emphasises that AI must always be used as a support tool, and never as a substitute, in the work activities of researchers and staff. Researchers and staff must maintain control and supervision over all stages of the process - in the case of research, at every stage from the formulation of hypotheses to the publication of results. It is essential that researchers and staff understand how the AI tools they use work and that they are able to critically interpret and validate the outputs generated through AI support.

2.2 Integrity

The principle of integrity requires that the results produced by AI technologies are accurate, reliable and obtained through ethical methods. The use of AI must in no way compromise these standards. Researchers and staff must ensure that AI technologies do not introduce bias or errors into the data and that the results obtained through their use are replicable and verifiable; they must also ensure that the use of AI technologies is carried out in a manner that respects the privacy of all stakeholders and complies with applicable copyright laws.

2.3 Transparency and traceability

It is essential that researchers and staff explicitly declare their use of AI technologies in their research processes and work activities. This includes a detailed documentation of the tools used, the data and prompts provided as input, and the elaboration processes through which the final outputs were produced. This information

can be conveyed through statements to be attached at the bottom of the outputs themselves, a possible example of which is provided at the end of this document.

2.4 Liability

Researchers and staff are fully and personally responsible for the outputs generated with the help of AI technologies. They must therefore be prepared to justify methodological and operational choices and to correct any errors and biases arising from the use of AI technologies. This responsibility also implies the need for every researcher and staff member to keep abreast of technological and regulatory developments related to AI.

3. Policies and recommendations

3.1 Policies and procedures

All IAI researchers and staff are required to respect the fundamental principles identified in section 2) in their research and operational activities. They must also make sure that any use of IA technologies fully complies with the regulations, policies and indications of the funding bodies and partners of the various projects in which they are to be used, as well as with the relevant regulations in force at national and EU level.

In the event of any doubts as to whether certain AI tools or the way in which they are used meet the above criteria, researchers and staff must preliminarily discuss and assess the issue with IAI's DPO.

3.2 Training and awareness-raising

IAI is committed to promoting training programmes to ensure that researchers and staff can be kept up-to-date on the opportunities and limitations of AI, following a line of activity that has already begun in 2023.

4. Applicable law: The EU AI Act

Regulation (EU) 2024/1689, known as the AI Act, is the first comprehensive regulatory framework on AI at the European level. The AI Act establishes specific requirements for the use of AI, with a focus on high-risk systems. Researchers and staff members are encouraged to familiarise themselves with the provisions of the AI Act and ensure that their practices comply with the regulations.

For a more in-depth look at the legal aspects of the AI Act, please refer to the annex '**Breve guida all'uso dell'IA conforme al Regolamento UE 2024/1689**' (in Italian only), which includes an overview of the requirements for high-risk systems, the implications for data management and possible sanctions in the event of violation.

Note: The drafting of this document was supported by the use of a generative Artificial Intelligence tool (ChatGPT, developed by OpenAI), employed under the full responsibility and supervision of the author. All content has been checked, validated and adapted in accordance with the ethical and methodological principles of Istituto Affari Internazionali. The English translation was supported by the use of DeepL.